

# Giang Vu Le

PhD Student in Economics

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## EDUCATION

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### PhD in Economics

2024 – Present

*IMT School for Advanced Studies Lucca, Italy*

Specialization: Industrial Policy and International Trade

### Master of Arts in Economic Policy

2022 – 2024

*Central European University, Vienna, Austria*

### Bachelor of Engineering in Aeronautical Engineering

2018 – 2022

*Ho Chi Minh City University of Technology, Vietnam*

## RESEARCH

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### Working Papers

#### “Picking the Right Winners? Optimal Policy Learning and Subsidies”

with Armando Rungi. Draft in preparation.

*Abstract.* We study the firm-level impact of German subsidies aimed at energy efficiency and evaluate whether alternative targeting rules could improve policy outcomes. We combine double machine learning with an optimal policy learning framework to estimate ex post heterogeneous treatment effects and derive ex ante optimal allocation rules. Applying a doubly robust learner, we find that subsidies increase capital stock and employment, on average, while documenting substantial heterogeneity across firms, indicating scope for improving targeting. Therefore, we assess two policies, each of which maximizes either employment or value added. We show how the employment-maximizing policy would disproportionately target smaller firms and yield larger job gains, while the value-added-maximizing policy would favor larger firms, leading to greater output and labor productivity.

## SKILLS

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**Programming Languages:** Python, R, Stata, MATLAB, SQL

**Statistical Methods:** Causal Inference, Machine Learning, Econometrics, Double Machine Learning

**Languages:** Vietnamese (Native), English (Fluent), Italian (Beginner)

## PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITY

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**Conferences & Presentations**

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**Professional Memberships**

with memberships)

**AWARDS & HONORS**

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dated with awards)